

Damn Delete Button!

Digit's photographer Mexy Xavier recounts her woes of accidentally deleting pictures.

The problem with cameras today is that every button and its resulting menu are a little too easily accessible. And what's more, as a shutterbug, I never seem to ever have enough space for photographs. Though, effectively, I have 1 GB of space for photographs (on two 512 MB compact flash cards) sometimes I wish cameras had hard disks attached to them.

It was just one of those days: I had barely walked into office and I found out that I would have to leave immediately for a shoot at the other end of town. If that wasn't bad enough, I had to attend four more events during the course of the day.

I sat down on my Apple Mac, quickly copied all images on my camera's compact flash card to it, and left before people could find even more work for me to do. The details of the rest of that day are unimportant, but some time during the day, I changed cards in the camera. Worried about running out of memory mid-shoot, I decided to delete some of the pictures that I was "sure" I had transferred to my Mac. I started browsing through the photographs already on the card, using my camera's LCD—these things should be made bigger!

I spotted a folder full of images from a press conference that I had covered two days ago. "Delete? Are you sure? Of course I'm sure! What kind of question is that? Ahh, there, so much more space. But wait, why can I still see the same folder with all the same images?"

It was then I realised that I had deleted the folder of images that I had just clicked in the morning, which also happened to be the most important event of the day. Just before I could tear my hair out, I remembered that one of the geeks at office was telling me about some recovery software that could recover files from flash media. I decided to follow His Geekiness' advice to the letter,